Parvaiyattam: Dancing for Sight

ILLUMINATING NAWALAPITIYA'S FUTURE

2023
2024



Prisha Kuberan, Kaustubh Grama, Saanvi Subramanian
Community Giving Project
Bothell High School
9130 NE 180th St, Bothell, WA 98011

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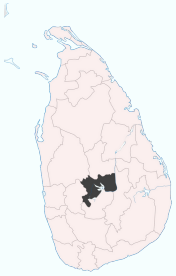
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I. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

DESCRIPTION OF PROBLEM

The Sri Lankan civil war has left smaller communities with heightened poverty rates and socioeconomic struggles, resulting in limited access to healthcare. In the small Tamil town of Nawalapitiya, located in Kandy District, **33%** of the population suffers from cataracts. Cataracts are a condition of cloudiness in the lens of the eye, resulting in a drastic decline in visual function. This condition has been associated with diminished quality of life and even increased physical injury/mortality rates among the elderly. Even though cataract surgery is remarkably safe (**98%** success rate), **67%** of Kandy District Sri Lankan cataract patients reported they were not able to afford the surgery.





OUR SOLUTION

We partnered with the Washington State Sri Lankan Tamil Association (WSSTA) to put together 2 performances of Bharatanatyam, a Tamil cultural dance, in an event called **Parvaiyattam** - Tamil for *Dancing for Sight*. All proceeds went to the Nawalapitiya General Hospital to purchase cataract surgical sets.



TARGET AUDIENCE

DEMOGRAPHICS:

- Tamils - South Asian ethnolinguistic group
  - Family audiences
- Age: 20-60 y.o.



PSYCHOGRAPHICS:

- Enjoy Tamil culture
- Interested in Bharatanatyam



GEOGRAPHICS:

- Greater Seattle Area, suburban locations



PROJECT GOALS

PURPOSE: To raise funds to aid the people of Nawalapitiya and restore their vision

1. **Raise $10,000 to fund cataract surgical sets in Nawalapitiya**
2. **Raise awareness about healthcare inequalities in Sri Lanka**

OUR TEAM



Prisha Kuberan
PROJECT LEAD
DANCE COORDINATOR



Kaustubh Grama
PROJECT LEAD
LOGISTICS COORDINATOR



Saanvi Subramanian
PROJECT LEAD
MARKETING COORDINATOR



Pratheeba Satkunanathan
WSSTA PRESIDENT



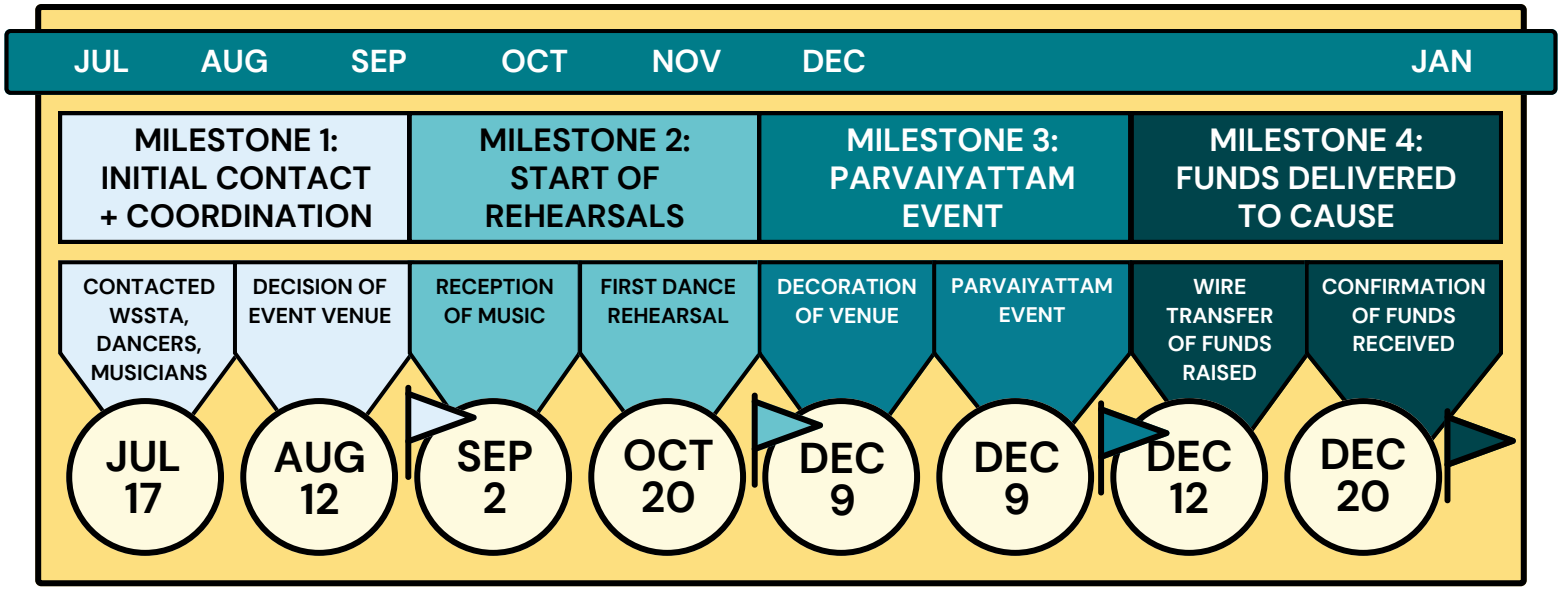
Nrityalaya Dancers
BHARATANATYAM PERFORMERS



Carnatic Musicians
MUSICIAN GROUP

I. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

SCHEDULE AND MILESTONES



QUALITY MANAGEMENT

Schedule

- ★ Created schedule checkpoints
- ★ ***KEY METRIC: Adherence to milestones (OTD)***

Financials

- ★ Monthly budget reviews with team
- ★ ***KEY METRIC: Budget variance***

Logistics

- ★ Conducted checks on venue cleanliness, seating availability, preparation of back-up equipment
- ★ Sent out a CSAT survey to attendees
- ★ ***KEY METRIC: CSAT score***

Mission Objectives

- ★ Reach out to understand our impact
- ★ ***KEY METRIC: Total funds raised, number of eye surgeries funded***

To ensure our project operated smoothly, we also tracked the **number of attendees** and **number of ticket sales**.

RISK MANAGEMENT

RISK	RESPONSE STRATEGY
Low Number of Attendees *Likelihood: LOW*	• Market with different channels • Advertise to local community • Offer free tickets for children • Offer tickets at the door
Injury to Performers *Likelihood: MODERATE*	• Implement safety protocols during rehearsals • Secure fill-in dancers from the Nrityalaya School of Dance
Falling Short of Donation Goals *Likelihood: HIGH*	• Monitor donation progress • Encourage additional donations from event attendees • Promote cause through posters

BUDGET

Item	Cost per Item	#	TOTAL COST
Lamp Decor	Donated	1	**$0.00**
Flower Decor	Donated	1	**$0.00**
Outfits	$20.50	10	**$205.00**
Venue	$100.00/hr	11 hrs	**$1100.00**
Musicians	$500.00	1	**$500.00**
Total Budget			**$1,805.00**

I. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

EXECUTION AND OUTCOMES

MILESTONE 1: INITIAL CONTACT AND COORDINATION

Kaustubh contacted WSSTA, the musician ensemble, and scouted dancers with Prisha to form the team.

MILESTONE 2: START OF REHEARSALS

After reserving the venue, Prisha choreographed the dance. She created a rehearsal schedule with the dancers, and held the first Parvaiyattam rehearsal.

ADVERTISING AND TICKET SELLING

Saanvi designed flyers and distributed them to South Asian centers. She sold tickets online using *Sulekha*.

MILESTONE 3: PARVAIYATTAM EVENT

The two Bharatanatyam dance productions of Parvaiyattam took place on **December 9, 2023**. The performances began with a talk from the WSSTA president about the injustices in Sri Lanka, and encouraged donations from attendees.

Renton IKEA Performing Arts Center

3:00 PM - 6:30 PM

7:00 PM - 10:30 PM



MILESTONE 4: DONATION OF FUNDS RAISED

We received confirmation from the Nawalapitiya General Hospital that our donation wire transfer was successful.

EVALUATION OF KEY METRICS

KEY METRIC	*STATUS*	*KEY METRIC*	*STATUS*
Adherence to milestones	⚠	CSAT score	✓
Budget variance	✓	Total funds raised	✓
# of ticket sales	✓	# of eye surgeries funded	✓
# of attendees	✓		

812 TOTAL NUMBER OF ATTENDEES

$22,568 TOTAL AMOUNT RAISED

423 CATARACT SURGERY SETS FUNDED

MONITORING

Created schedule checkpoints for each milestone.

Held budget reviews, tracked expenses with Excel.

Implemented a quality management plan to ensure project operated smoothly, and audience satisfaction of event.

CONTROLLING

- One dancer was injured
- Low amount of ticket sales
- Poor dance synchronization
- Secured alternate dancer to fill in
- Advertised to local community centers
- Held team-bonding activities for dancers

LESSONS LEARNED

- Plan for delays in international communication
- Should become aware of opportunities for nonprofits to increase impact
- Target a broader audience

RECOMMENDATIONS FOR FUTURE PROJECTS

- Research community programs
- Expand target demographics
- Utilize more social media channels

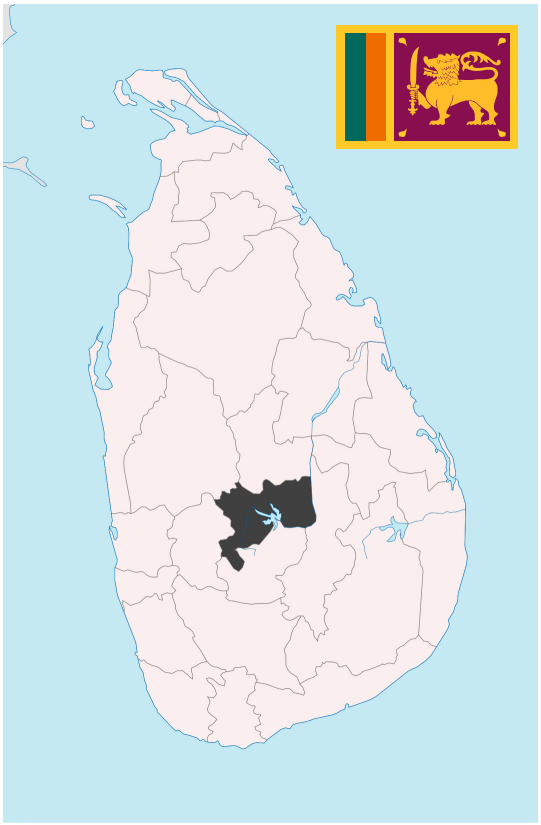
II. INITIATING

A. Statement of the problem

The lasting effects of the Sri Lankan civil conflict have left **Nawalapitiya**, a small suburban town in **Kandy District, Sri Lanka**, with challenges of limited healthcare access and heightened poverty rates. The community struggles with eye health, particularly with regard to cataracts.

Cataract remains the leading cause of blindness. The *National Eye Institute* describes cataracts as cloudy areas in the lens of the eye that significantly affect day-to-day life. Examples include limitations in mobility, activities of daily living, and physical performance. Blindness and visual impairment are not only health issues for the elderly but also significantly affect the quality of their lives.

In Kandy District, an estimated **33%** of people experience impaired vision from complications of cataracts. In a *National Library of Medicine* (NLM) paper, researchers found that out of 470 elders (people over the age of 60), 379 (or 80.6%) were found to have some kind of cataract. This study demonstrated lack of awareness and knowledge, socioeconomic factors, and misconceptions as the main barriers to cataract treatment, leading to a lower cataract surgery rate irrespective of the high cataract prevalence reported. Findings of this study highlight the importance of cataracts as a common health problem in the elderly and recommend eliminating barriers to its treatment - i However, it is reported that **67%** of Kandy district cataract patients cannot afford treatment.



Map showing Kandy District, Sri Lanka

33%

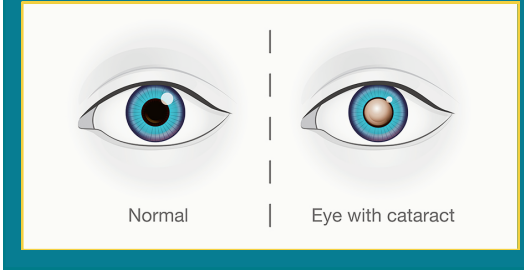
KANDY DISTRICT POPULATION AFFECTED BY CATARACT

67%

CATARACT PATIENTS CANNOT AFFORD SURGERY

CATARACTS

- Cloudy area in the lens of eye
- Make vision blurry, hazy, or less colorful
- Decrease quality of life
- Can only be cured through surgery



Cataracts are curable, but only with cataract eye surgery. This surgery is safe and effective, helping 98% of people with no complications. Unfortunately, **the price of cataract eye surgery is simply unaffordable for Nawalapitiya residents.** With Parvaiyattam, we aim to make a difference in the community by making better cataract surgery treatments available and helping those affected regain their vision to lead happier, healthier lives.

98%

CATARACT SURGERY SUCCESS RATE

B. Project scope

Description of project

This project aimed to deliver funds to the Nawalapitiya community to provide cataract surgical sets for those affected by the condition. Towards this, we created a fundraising project by partnering with WSSTA - the Washington State Sri Lankan Tamil Association - to put together two performances of Bharatanatyam, a Tamil cultural dance, in an event called **Parvaiyattam** (*Dancing for Sight*)**.** Our goals were 1) to raise funds by selling tickets for the event and encouraging donations from attendees for the Nawalapitiya General Hospital and 2) to create awareness about the healthcare inequalities in Sri Lanka. The project comprised the planning and logistics for the event, campaigns through organic and social media reach, performance, and delivery of funds to provide access to eye care for the community.



Bharatanatyam - a Tamil cultural dance performed with a group of trained dancers in cultural attire



Nawalapitiya General Hospital - a district hospital in Sri Lanka providing healthcare services to 3,000+ people

TARGET AUDIENCE

DEMOGRAPHICS:
- Tamil families
- South Asians
- Age: 20-60 y.o.



GEOGRAPHICS:
- Greater Seattle Area
- Suburban locations



PSYCHOGRAPHICS:
- Enjoy Tamil culture
- Interested in Bharatanatyam



PROBLEM IDENTIFIED

Civil conflict in Sri Lanka created socioeconomic difficulties and healthcare challenges for small, Tamil towns, specifically with cataract

OUR CAUSE

Help fund cataract surgical equipment in Nawalapitiya



OUR PROJECT

Parvaiyattam event:
2 Tamil classical dance performances to raise money and awareness to aid Nawalapitiya

PARTNERING NONPROFIT

WSSTA - Washington State Sri Lankan Tamil Association



வாஷிங்டன் மாநில இலங்கை தமிழ்ச் சங்கம்

WASHINGTON STATE SRI LANKAN TAMIL ASSOCIATION

Purpose

Parvaiyattam focused on raising funds (goal: $10,000) for the Nawalapitiya General Hospital in collaboration with WSSTA. With these funds, 187 cataract surgery equipment sets could be distributed. Cataract surgery can last as little as 10 minutes, but the benefits are worthwhile for a lifetime of clear vision. It allows people to reconnect visually, socially, and emotionally with their loved ones, improving their quality of life. It also significantly reduces the chance of severe physical injury in elders, reducing future treatment costs. By making cataract surgery a possibility for the people of Nawalapitiya, we can lead them to a brighter and more sustainable future.

Rationale

Tamils are an ethno-linguistic group located in South Asia. Hearing about the devastating plight of Tamils in Sri Lanka following their Civil War, we reached out to the Washington State Sri Lankan Tamil Association (WSSTA) to understand more about the issue and how we could help. We learned about the limited access to healthcare and how it disproportionately affects small communities. Higher costs are associated with acquiring healthcare necessities and procedures for those in rural areas, as there is high demand in contrast to limited access. Unfortunately, rural/small-town populations cannot afford treatment, even for relatively simple concerns, such as cataracts.

We identified the small town of Nawalapitiya, located in Kandy District, which currently struggles with limited healthcare access, most prevalently regarding cataracts. Cataracts are the clouding in the clear eye lens, often drastically inhibiting the patient's field of vision and affecting 33% of Kandy District. Cataracts are associated with subsequent physical disability and have even been correlated to increased mortality. Regardless of the cause, decreased visual function is associated with diminished quality of life and general function.

Fortunately, cataract surgery is a remarkably safe outpatient procedure that rarely produces complications, boasting a 98% success rate. Cataract surgery causes significant improvement in visual function and cognitive, emotional, and general well-being. Unfortunately, a survey published by the National Institute of Health reveals that a staggering 67% of those affected by cataracts in Kandy District responded "no" when asked if they were able to pay for surgery.

Upon learning about the debilitating effects of cataracts, we wanted to create a project to assist Nawalapitiya's journey to clear vision and a brighter future. **We wanted our project to involve Tamil culture to appeal to the Tamil and South Asian communities of the greater Seattle area in order to attract people who would be most inclined to support the cause and enjoy Bharatanatyam.**

Expected Benefits

From the Parvaiyattam project, we can expect the following benefits:

- **Raise funds for cataract surgical equipment in Nawalapitiya**
- **Promote Tamil culture through cultural dance and connect with community**
- **Raise awareness about socioeconomic and healthcare inequalities in Sri Lanka**

III. PLANNING AND ORGANIZING



A. Project goals

Primary - Finance: Raise $10,000 for cataract surgical equipment

The primary goal of the Parvaiyattam project was to raise enough money to help alleviate the costs associated with **187** cataract surgeries in Nawalapitiya, given the calculated cost of **a set of one-time use surgical equipment** is $53.31 (USD). The breakdown of this cost is as follows: $2.17 for a phaco knife (used for clear corneal incision (CCI), near corneal incisions and scleral tunnel incisions in cataract surgery), $4.65 for vision blue dye (a sterile solution used for medical aid), $9.30 for methyl cellulose (used to relieve dry, irritated eyes), and $37.19 for a pair of lenses to finish the cataract surgery.

Item	Price in rupees	Price in dollars
Phaco knife	Rs. 700	$2.17
Vision blue dye	Rs. 1,500	$4.65
Methyl cellulose	Rs. 3,000	$9.30
Lenses	Rs. 12,000	$37.19
Total	Rs. 17,200	$53.31



A cataract surgical set

These funds were raised by selling tickets for the event - $20 tickets, with free entry for children under the age of 10. To meet this goal, we planned to sell 450 tickets to the event and raise $1,000 by encouraging additional donations from event attendees.

***TARGET**: $9,000 from ticket sales, $1,000 from donations*

Secondary - Community Awareness: Raise awareness about the significant impacts of healthcare inequalities in Sri Lanka

The secondary objective was to raise awareness about the limited healthcare access in Nawalapitiya and their struggles with cataract-related vision impairment. We did this by opening the Parvaiyattam event with a speech from the WSSTA president about the issues that Sri Lanka is facing due to civil conflict, specifically regarding to healthcare inequalities in smaller cities. This topic was the main focus of the event, with detailed posters put in place to explain the problem and demonstrate the impact of any donations on the lives of those in Nawalapitiya. By raising community awareness, especially within the South Asian community, we can impart positive change to Nawalapitiya and help countless people see the world better.

B. Human resource management plan

Our team consisted of three DECA members who organized and ran the Parvaiyattam event, the WSSTA President, and the dancers and musicians who partook in the productions.

Our Team:



PRISHA KUBERAN *– Project Lead and Dance Coordinator*

Responsibilities: Leading the project, choreographing dance routines, coordinating rehearsals, initiating contact with WSSTA, and ensuring the execution of the entire initiative.

Strengths and skills: Strong leadership, project management, communication.

Prisha organized the dance productions, serving as the choreographer and coordinator for the group of dancers. Additionally, she initiated contact with WSSTA.



KAUSTUBH GRAMA *– Project Lead and Logistics Coordinator*

Responsibilities: Managing finances, contacting external contributors, finding a suitable venue, and overseeing strategic planning to ensure the success of the initiative.

Strengths and skills: Financial acumen, strategic planning, communication.

Kaustubh led the logistics, strategic planning, and financial aspects of the project. He managed finances and played a crucial role in planning, including contacting singers in India and securing an appropriate venue.



SAANVI SUBRAMANIAN *– Project Lead and Marketing Coordinator*

Responsibilities: Designing posters, finding a ticket selling platform and enabling its use, connecting with local temples and community organizations, sharing event through online platforms.

Strengths and skills: Social media, graphic design, event marketing, and advertisement.

Saanvi advertised the Parvaiyattam event and sold tickets through *Sulekha*, an online platform. She designed posters to spread the word and shared them with local organizations and online social media platforms including Whatsapp and Facebook.



PRATHEEBA SATKUNANATHAN *– WSSTA President and Sponsor of Event*

Responsibilities: Connecting with the hospital, securing funding, fostering collaboration, and advocating for the project within the wider community of Sri Lankan Tamils.

Strengths and skills: Networking, community engagement.

Pratheeba Satkunanathan provided financial support for the initiative and facilitated collaboration between the project and the hospital.



BHARATANATYAM DANCERS *Varshni Iyer, Joshitha Velmurugan, Adthvika Charu, Akchara Arun, Meghna Sekaran, Kanika Saravanan, Thanushri & Krithi Narandren, Bavishya Rajasekar, Prisha Kuberan*

Responsibilities: Learning and performing dance routines, actively participating in rehearsals, and contributing to the artistic success of the Bharatanatyam productions.

Strengths and skills: Bharatanatyam dancing, teamwork, commitment.

These 10 dancers contributed to the artistic success of the project through commitment, teamwork, and active involvement in rehearsals and performances.



CARNATIC MUSICIANS *N. K. Srividya – Vocal, R. L. Srivatsa – Flute, B. T. Mayan – Percussion, T. N. Rajesh – Rhythm Pad*

Responsibilities: Rehearse together and audio recordings of requested songs.

Strengths and skills: South Asian classical music, experience with Bharatanatyam music.

Located in Chennai, India, these musicians contributed to the musical success of the production through their expertise in Carnatic classical music and accompanying the Bharatanatyam dancers.

C. Schedule

i. Milestone

MILESTONE 1	MILESTONE 2	MILESTONE 3	MILESTONE 4
			
Initial Contact and Coordination	Start of Rehearsals	Parvaiyattam Event	Funds Delivered to Cause

MILESTONE 1: INITIAL CONTACT AND COORDINATION



Description: The first milestone of the project comprises the following activities: contacting WSSTA to initiate collaboration and confirm project feasibility, coordinating with the Nrityalaya School of Dance dancers, reaching out to the musicians, and assessing the venue - leading to identifying and reserving the Renton IKEA Performing Arts Center. During this phase, we also defined our goals for the project, identified resources, and prepared a high-level schedule. This milestone marks the completion of the initial stages of the project. Once we received confirmation from the involved organizations, we were able to begin preparations for the Parvaiyattam event.

Activities: Initial discussions, project proposal, communication with WSSTA and hospital representatives, venue reservation	**Outcome:** Confirmation of collaboration, project planning and viability, venue reservation

MILESTONE 2: START OF REHEARSALS



Description: With the musical arrangements in place, rehearsals for the Bharatanatyam production commenced. We formed a team of dancers and recruited musicians to help prepare for the performance. This included separate dance and music rehearsals, with dress rehearsals leading to the event date. Dance rehearsals were at Nrityalaya School of Dance in Redmond, WA, and musician rehearsals were at their residences in Chennai, India. Dance practices were planned to be intense for at least 15 hours a week in the 2 months leading up to the performance.

Activities: Receiving music recordings, choreography sessions, practice schedules, coordination with dancers	**Outcome:** Music recordings finalized, Initiation of dance rehearsals, ensuring preparation for the upcoming production

MILESTONE 3: PARVAIYATTAM EVENT



Description: The Parvaiyattam event was planned for Saturday, December 9th at the Renton IKEA Performing Arts Center, and consisted of two complete productions: the first from 3:00 pm to 6:30 pm, and the second from 7:00 pm to 10:30 pm. This was done to maximize contributors' attendance and optimize our total funds raised. Both productions were held on the same day to minimize venue rental costs. Each paying attendee contributed $20 in ticket sales, while children under 10 were admitted free of cost. Throughout the event, we invited speakers from WSSTA to speak about Tamils in Sri Lanka and the limited access to healthcare in rural areas, helping us achieve our secondary goal of raising awareness for our cause.

Activities: Decorating the venue, two showings of Parvaiyattam dance performances, posters and talks on cause	**Outcome:** Funds raised in ticket sales, increased awareness about healthcare inequities in Sri Lanka

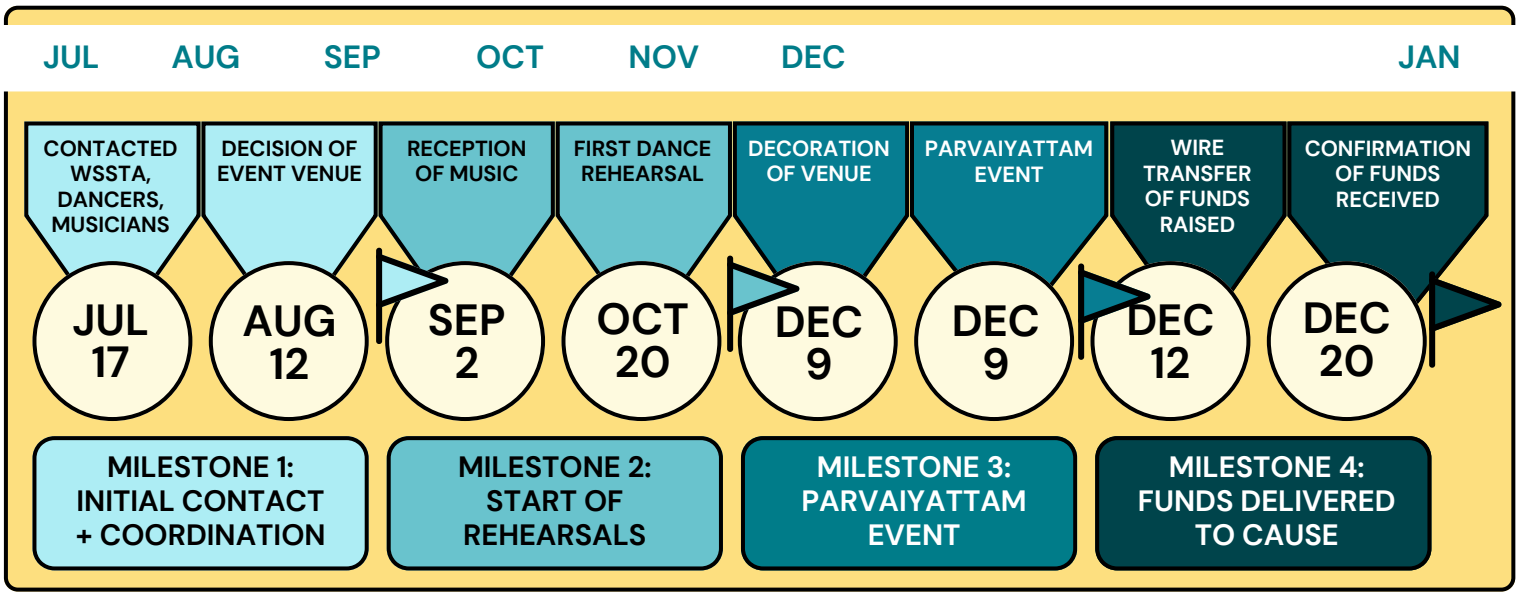
MILESTONE 4: FUNDS DELIVERED TO CAUSE



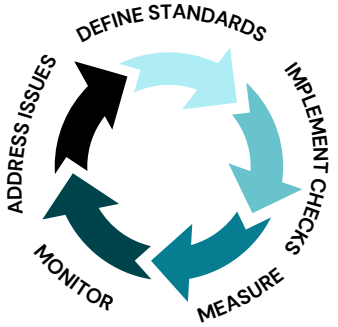
Description: Following the completion of the Parvaiyattam event, we formally presented the Washington State Sri Lankan Tamil Association with the money raised from the project. The money was then sent to the director of the Nawalapitiya General Hospital to purchase cataract surgery equipment. We confirmed the funds were successfully received by the Nawalapitiya General Hospital through contact via email.

Activities: Wire transfer of collected funds from WSSTA to Nawalapitiya General Hospital, confirm money transfer	**Outcome:** Provide access to cataract surgery for residents of Nawalapitiya, donate funds raised, ensure quality

ii. Timeline to reach each milestone



D. Quality management plan



We created a holistic quality plan to ensure that our project operated smoothly. This comprised addressing the desired outcomes on our **schedule, financials, logistics**, and **mission objectives**. Quality management includes defining the quality standards, managing the control parameters, and a plan validating the event's quality objectives. Communication channels were established, ensuring quality issues were addressed in the earliest time. We identified the following quality metrics, along with general metrics of **number of attendees** and **number of ticket sales.**

SCHEDULE



Ensuring the schedule involves having mechanisms that ensure the timeliness of event parameters. We will schedule regular checkpoints to validate the venue's availability and preparations leading to the event. Validations on preparations include signage at the event, setting up the event hall, marking the parking areas, and ensuring the availability of parking access. We set up additional checkpoints on weather conditions and potential events in the neighborhood to prepare for contingencies.

KEY METRICS: Adherence to milestones (On-time delivery)

FINANCIALS



We worked within strict constraints on the allocated budget. We set up monthly reviews on cost incurrence and deviations from the budget. We also recognized the need to ensure a safe, trusted way of receiving donations from our patrons. We diligently reviewed vendor products to identify the most reliable means for donations that comprehensively address privacy and identity risks. Our chosen vendor met industry and regulatory standards for financial certifications.

KEY METRICS: Budget variance

LOGISTICS



Our team conducted rigorous checks to ensure the program ran smoothly and that the performers and attendees had a great experience. To this end, we set up an extensive list of event logistics—availability of seating, cleanliness of event space, and setting up backup microphones—to name a few. We will also send out a post-event survey to attendees to measure their satisfaction with the event.

KEY METRICS: CSAT score

MISSION OBJECTIVES



Finally, we defined quality objectives for the impact of the entire project, which ultimately was the number of people treated from the funds raised. We ensured successful transfer of the funds, and measured impact from the donations to confirm that the funds delivered the intended objective.

KEY METRICS: Total funds raised, number of eye surgeries funded

E. Risk management plan

RISK	IMPACT	RESPONSE STRATEGY
 **Low Number of Attendees** *Likelihood: LOW* 	**Detrimental** • Reduced fundraising success • Diminished community involvement	• Enhanced marketing and promotion through different channels • Advertise to local community • Offer free tickets for children • Offer tickets at the door
 **Injury to Performers** *Likelihood: MODERATE* 	**Detrimental** • Production severely impacted through the absence of a part of the performance	• Implement strict safety protocols during rehearsals • Maintain a pool of back-up dancers from the Nrityalaya School of Dance to fill in
 **Falling Short of Donation Objectives** *Likelihood: HIGH* 	**Detrimental** • Unable to meet project goals ◦ Reduced number of surgical sets funded for	• Continuously monitor donation progress • Encourage additional donations from event attendees • Further promote cause through posters

F. Proposed project budget

Item	Cost per Item	#	TOTAL COST
Lamp Decor	In-Kind from Nrityalaya	1	**$0.00**
Flower Decor	In-Kind from Nrityalaya	1	**$0.00**
Bharatanatyam Outfit	$20.50	10	**$205.00**
Renton IKEA Rental	$100.00/hour	11 hrs	**$1100.00**
Accompaniment Group	$500.00	1	**$500.00**
GRAND TOTAL			**$1,805.00**

WSSTA agreed to cover a maximum of $4,000.00 for the costs associated with the program. Being mindful of their contribution, we wanted to minimize our costs and take advantage of donations. Nrityalaya School of Dance provided production decorations, most of which were recycled from prior events. Additionally, we were able to secure microphones and audio equipment free of cost from the Renton IKEA Performing Arts Center. Altogether, we projected a budget of **$1,805.00** for the Parvaiyattam event.

IV. EXECUTION



MILESTONE 1: INITIAL CONTACT AND COORDINATION

We initially coordinated with the Washington State Sri Lankan Tamil Association (WSSTA), Nrityalaya School of Dance, accompanying musicians, and the Renton IKEA Performing Arts Center for the project. We contacted the president of WSSTA to finalize our idea of holding Bharatanatyam performances in an event, and she connected us with representatives from Nawalapitiya General Hospital. We worked with Nrityalaya to scout our 10 leading dancers, including Prisha, as well as six emergency replacement dancers. We reached out to 4 Carnatic musicians in Chennai, India, who had connections with Nrityalaya: Srividya for singing, Srivatsa on percussion, Mayan on flute, and Rajesh on rhythm pad. After identifying our team, we confirmed our date with the Renton IKEA Performing Arts Center and proceeded with operations accordingly.



Renton IKEA Performing Arts Center



வாஷிங்டன் மாநில
இலங்கை தமிழ்ச் சங்கம்

WASHINGTON STATE
SRI LANKAN TAMIL ASSOCIATION



MILESTONE 2: START OF REHEARSALS

Kaustubh coordinated with the group of artists and sent them a list of the 9 songs needed for 2 productions. Kaustubh asked that the recordings be sent on September 2nd so that the dancers and Nrityalaya teachers would have adequate time to rehearse with the music.

Prisha was in charge of managing the dance rehearsals and choreography of the 9 pieces. Before rehearsals began, Prisha set a rigorous practice regimen for each week leading up to the production, lasting 2 months. Prisha coordinated with the dancers to set practice times leading up to the event. She requested that everyone enter their availabilities into a shared Excel spreadsheet so that she could get a sense of what times work for the dancers. Once everyone populated the spreadsheet, she chose the least occupied times, and the dancers rearranged their commitments accordingly.

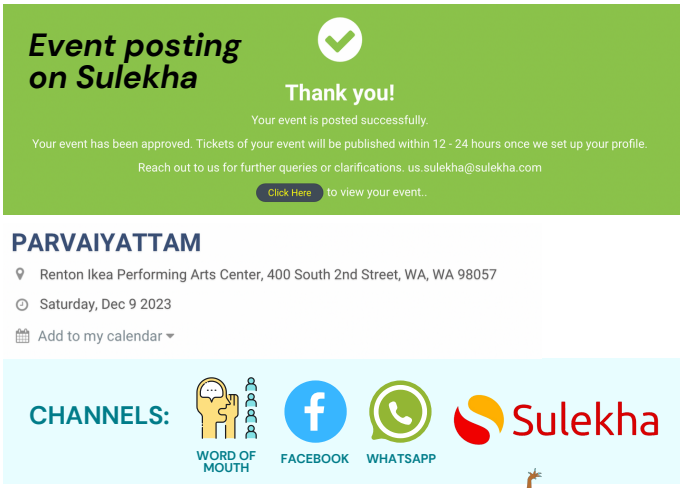
Name	Day	Please note that the finalized schedule will be for the next three months!					
	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday	Sunday
Prisha	5:00 pm - 9:00pm	NONE	5:00-9:30	NONE	5:00-9:00	7:00-12:00	7:00-12:00
Varshini	NONE	5:00- 7:00	5:00-9:30	NONE	NONE	ALL DAY	ALL DAY
Karishma	1:00 pm - 7 :00pm	NONE	5:00-9:30	NONE	1:00-7:00	9:00-10:00	9:00-10:00
Akchara	7:00 pm- 9:00pm	6:00-7:00	5:00-9:30	7:00-9:00	7:00-9:00	8:00-11:00	8:00-11:00
Tanu	5:00 pm - 9:00 pm	7:00-9:00	5:00-9:30	NONE	5:00-9:00	9:00-12:00	9:00-12:00
Krithi	5:00pm- 9 pm	NONE	5:00- 7:00	NONE	5:00-9:00	ALL DAY	ALL DAY
Advika	NONE	6:00-9:00	5:00-9:30	5:00-9:00	NONE	9:00-12:00	9:00-12:00
Joshitha	5:00pm - 7:00pm	NONE	5:00-8:45	NONE	5:00-7:00	7:00-9:00	7:00-9:00
Kanika	7:00 pm- 9:00pm	6:00-9:00	5:00-9:30	5:00-8:00	7:00-9:00	8:00-12:00	8:00-12:00
Bavishya	6:00 pm- 9:00pm	5:00-9:00	5:00-9:30	NONE	6:00-9:00	7:00-9:00	7:00-9:00
Finalized Schedule:		**Please confirm this by marking the boxes with your color!**					
Monday - 5:00pm - 8:30 pm							
Wednesday- 5:00pm - 8:30pm							
Friday - 5:00pm - 8:30pm							
Saturday -9:00am - 12:00pm							
Sunday - 9:00 am - 12:00 pm							

ADVERTISING AND TICKET SELLING



Saanvi was in charge of advertising the Parvaiyattam event and finding and setting up the ticket-selling platform. She designed the flyers shown to the right. She distributed them to Hindu temples and Tamil schools around the greater Seattle area to attract the South Asian community and local businesses willing to promote the event. She also realized that digital advertising would be effective, as it could better target South Asian people who may be interested in this cultural event and allow for easier spreading of the event information. She sent out digital copies of the flyer on platforms such as Facebook and WhatsApp to attract family audiences of South Asians and others who may be interested in learning more about its culture.

Saanvi chose to sell tickets for the event through the platform *Sulekha*, an online platform dedicated to South Asian community events. She thought it would be a perfect platform for Parvaiyattam and another channel by which we could advertise the event. Sulekha also does not charge a commission fee, so no operating costs were associated with the platform, another driving factor contributing to our choice. We also offered the opportunity to purchase tickets at the door.



MILESTONE 3: PARVAIYATTAM EVENT



Parvaiyattam was held on Saturday, December 9th, 2023, at Renton IKEA Performing Arts Center. The event consisted of two complete productions: the first from 3:00 pm to 6:30 pm and the second from 7:00 pm to 10:30 pm. This was done to maximize contributors' attendance and optimize our total funds raised. Both productions were held on the same day to minimize venue rental costs.

Before attendees arrived, the dancers completed rehearsal from 12:00 pm to 2:30 pm. During this time, the parents of the dancers volunteered to decorate and prepare the venue for guests. They also set up a ticket-selling booth to allow for on-the-spot sales, set up next to our posters that advertised our cause.



Before the two performances began, we invited Pratheeba Satkunanathan and a couple of other WSSTA officials to talk about the socioeconomic injustices of Tamils in Sri Lanka, and the limited access to healthcare in rural areas. This helped us achieve our secondary goal of raising awareness for our cause.

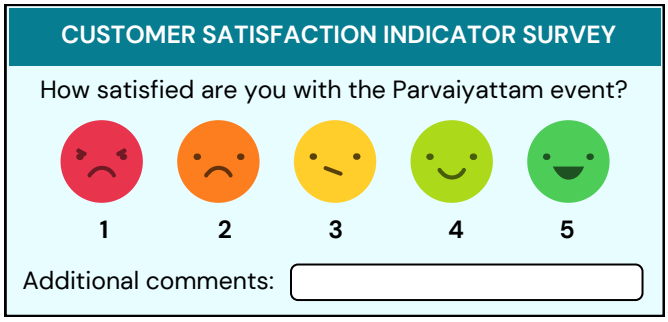


10 Bharatanatyam dancers performed in the event, and we had **812** total guests at the venue (**337** and **475** in the first and second showings, respectively), out of which were **501** paying attendees - **299** in the first performance and **202** in the second performance. We raised **$10,020** through organic ticket sales and **$1,264** from additional donations, for a total of **$11,284** raised.

The dancers performed 9 pieces showcasing Tamil culture, depicting episodes from the Sri Lankan civil war, and how it affected Sri Lankan Tamils. The pieces were set to music recordings provided by our accompaniment team in Chennai.



We printed out QR codes that when scanned, directed guests to a short, online survey assessing attendee satisfaction. At the end of each program, we thanked the attendees for coming and encouraged them to scan the QR codes to provide feedback from the event.



MILESTONE 4: FUNDS DELIVERED TO CAUSE

Our team met with Pratheeba Satkunanathan (WSSTA President) on December 11, 2023, to discuss the next steps. The money we collected in ticket sales and donations was held in Saanvi's personal bank account linked with Sulekha. When we met with Pratheeba, we found out about the Microsoft Matching Gifts Program, and she provided us with the contact information of a WSSTA member whom we could contact to help us with the process. Once we got Microsoft to match our funds, we transferred the money to the WSSTA bank account. On December 23, we got confirmation from the Nawalapitiya General Hospital's Director, Maduwantha Dissanayake, that our wire transfer was successful. The order of 423 sets of cataract equipment was placed on December 28, 2023; as of April 5th, they have been used to aid in 102 surgeries.

MICROSOFT MATCHING GIFTS PROGRAM

Doubling the Donation

In our efforts to maximize our impact, we continued to look for more ways to increase our funds after the event. After discussing various options with WSSTA and the Parvaiyattam team, we stumbled across the Microsoft Matching Gifts Program. The Microsoft Matching Gifts Program is a corporate initiative encouraging employees to donate to eligible non-profits. Microsoft matches donations, effectively doubling the impact of their contributions, showcasing the company's commitment to corporate social responsibility. Leveraging this unique opportunity, we sought out Microsoft employees who were willing to aid in our impact. We met with a WSSTA member who was a Microsoft employee and had participated in the company's matching program before. We then transferred the funds to this trusted personnel, and applied to the program, designating the donation for WSSTA. Our application was successful, and by presenting the contribution as a charitable donation to a non-profit, **Microsoft matched our amount, effectively doubling the impact of our fundraising efforts.**



EVALUATING OUR IMPACT

The **$22,568.00** raised through our efforts will fund cataract surgery equipment sets for **423** people to help cure their cataracts, greatly exceeding our original goals of raising ten thousand dollars to help 187 patients! From the time of donation to April 5th, the Nawalapitiya General Hospital was able to complete 102 successful cataract surgeries, as depicted in the photos below. These people are now able to connect with their loved ones, contribute to their community, and live safer, more fulfilling lives.

501
PAYING ATTENDEES

$22.5K
TOTAL MONEY RAISED

423
SURGERY SETS PURCHASED

102
PATIENTS HELPED SO FAR





V. MONITORING AND CONTROLLING

A. Monitoring

Schedule

To monitor the schedule of the project, we established checkpoints to ensure we were on track to achieve our milestones. By utilizing the checkpoints below, we were able to organize dates for what needs to be completed and the process by which to address the task best. We tracked our adherence to milestones to assess our on time delivery. This helped us hold ourselves accountable for the completion of tasks needed to ensure the quality of the event.

SCHEDULE CHECKPOINT	DATE STARTED	PROCESS COMPLETED	DATE COMPLETED
Establish Collaboration with WSSTA ☑	July 10, 2023	Contacted WSSTA President about cause and finalized idea for event	July 13, 2023
Artist Coordination ☑	July 14, 2023	Scouted dancers and confirmed collaboration with accompaniment team	July 17, 2023
Event Planning (Time, Location, Date, Concept) ☑	July 17, 2023	Connected with venue and booked Renton IKEA Performing Arts Center	August 12, 2023
Music Recordings ☑	July 17, 2023	Requested and received Accompaniment team's music recordings for event	September 2nd, 2023
Advertising Parvaiyattam ☑	September 2nd, 2023	Distributed flyers to community organizations, through digital channels and a ticketing platform	December 8th, 2023
Day of Event ☑	December 9th, 2023	Parvaiyattam production set up and execution	December 9th, 2023
Funds Delivered ☑	December 11th, 2023	Worked with WSSTA to send funds to Nawalapitiya General Hospital	December 23rd, 2023 ***Checkpoint delayed**

Budget



WSSTA agreed to cover the costs of the Parvaiyattam event, as long as costs did not exceed $4,000. We monitored the event's costs through maintaining an Excel spreadsheet and holding monthly budget check-ins with the Parvaiyattam team during the planning process to go over the costs for the event. After the event, we evaluated the project's financials, as shown below.

Initial investment: $1,805.00
Total revenue: $22,568.00

Return on Investment: $20,763 ⇨ ***1150% ROI***

Quality

To ensure our project quality was held to the highest standards, we created a holistic quality management plan. This plan was in effect for the entirety of project timeline and closely tracked through the execution until the funds were delivered and impact was validated. Throughout the project, we informed the team of issues and responses. Checkpoints were proactively tracked, and identified issues were mitigated immediately. Our rigor on quality management was critical to the success of the program.

B. Controlling

As we prepared for the Parvaiyattam event, we encountered a few issues. While these issues initially posed a risk, by planning for them in our risk management phase, we were able to address them in a timely and orderly manner. These issues did not result in any significant impact to Parvaiyattam, and we were able to execute the project despite them.

PROBLEM ENCOUNTERED	SOLUTION IMPLEMENTED
One of the central dancers injured their legs 3 weeks before the performance.	We were able to fix this issue with the 6 extra dancers from Nrityalaya. Prisha spent extra time dedicated to teaching her the choreography and timing so she would be able to fulfill the role of the injured dancer.
In the first two weeks of ticket sales opening, we noticed that not as many people were purchasing tickets as we initially hoped.	To fix this, Saanvi advertised to various Tamil schools around the Greater Seattle Area and to the Nrityalaya School of Dance to broaden audience and propel ticket sales.
During the second month of rehearsals, we noticed that the dancers were having a hard time synchronizing in group dances.	To fix this, Prisha organized activities like movies, dinners, shopping, and sleepovers to strengthen bonds among dancers. Dancers brought the choreography to life by working together and dancing as one.

VI. CLOSING THE PROJECT



A. Evaluation of key metrics

To best assess our progress fulfilling our key metrics throughout the project, we established corresponding targets to which we could compare our outcomes. The outcomes and targets along with their relative metrics are displayed in the table below.

KEY METRIC	TARGET	OUTCOME	STATUS
Adherence to milestones (OTD)	0 delays	1 delay	⚠
Budget variance	$0	$0	✓
Number of ticket sales	450	501	✓
Number of attendees	450	812	✓
Customer satisfaction score	4	4.5	✓
Total funds raised	$10,000	$22,568	✓
Number of eye surgeries funded	187	423	✓

B. Lessons learned

Initiating

In the initiating phase, we were successful in our planned tasks. We received **financial assistance from WSSTA, selected specific and measurable objectives, and selected a fundraising medium in which we had expertise**. However, we had some **trouble coordinating with the international members of the team**. Keeping everyone updated proved to be difficult as many were on different schedules due to time zone variations.



Planning

In the planning and organizing, we were successful in establishing **attainable and timely objectives** for each key metric to accurately monitor progress, establishing an accompanying **timeline** to ensure we are on track to achieve objects, preparing a realistic **budget**, and establishing **backup plans** for mishaps. However, we did not plan for the **Microsoft Matching Gifts program**, which caused a **delay** in sending the funds.



Execution

During our execution, we were successful in using our **existing connections** (Nrithyalaya School of Dance) to source our artists, **advertising** through channels dedicated to South Asians, holding **2 programs** to maximize ticket sales, and using the **Microsoft Matching Gifts Program** to double our impact. However, we want to **broaden** and **diversify** our audience, and use more social media channels.



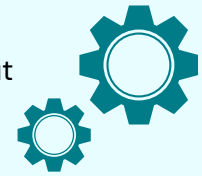
Monitoring

We were successful in establishing checkpoints and reviewing our budget. We could do better in **researching community programs beforehand** to stick to our schedule checkpoints.



Controlling

During our controlling phase, we were successful in **mitigating risks** we encountered throughout the project and **ensuring our team was on task**.



C. Recommendations for future projects

Running and managing the Parvaiyattam project has been an insightful experience, and one in which our team learned many lessons. For future projects, we recommend the following:

★ Research Existing Community Programs

Luckily, we found the Microsoft Matching opportunity after the event but before transferring the funds we raised. However, with this knowledge, our recommendation would be to research existing community programs to take advantage of them in order to maximize impact for future projects. We can also look for other community programs to identify areas where our goals align with theirs, and also establish partnerships with relevant organizations to reach a broader audience.

★ Expand Target Demographics

For the Parvaiyattam event, we prioritized marketing to a South Asian audience, since we believed they would be most likely to attend a Tamil cultural event and resonate with our cause. In future projects, we could diversify our target audience to increase our event audience, and maximize impact.

★ Utilize More Social Media Channels

We advertised the event with social channels, specifically Whatsapp and Facebook. However, for future projects, we should utilize more social media channels, like Instagram, to broaden our audience. By utilizing Instagram, we can target younger demographics. With a larger, more diverse audience, we would have greater ticket sales and therefore maximize our impact.

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